Internal Branding: Exploring the Employee Perspective

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Abstract

Employees are the vital link in building relationships with all the stakeholders as they are required to convey the significance of the brand and act as brand ambassadors. This research study explores the effect of internal brandingon organisation's human capital . The objective of this study is to develop and standardise scales to assess internal branding from employee and employer perspective. Usingreliability tests such as Cronbach's alpha, Split half test and ANOVA, a 49 item scale for the employer and a 68 item scale for employees for measuring internal branding are generated. Analysis of the data collected from 74 participants in IT, telecom, banking and aviation industry in India shows that internal branding is related to organizational factors such as OCTAPACE culture,communication and information, management support, leadership, teamwork, HR processes, engagement, citizenship behavior and employer brand equity.

Keywords: Brand, Internal Branding, Employer Branding, Engagement, Communication

Introduction

Internal Branding is a relatively new approach, which enables companies to focus on organisational vision, mission and values. Organisations, in today's competitive environment,

continue in their struggle to carve out their competitive niche in the marketplace. The creation of a strong brand and the deliverance of perceived service quality are premised by employees' ability to deliver on customer expectations. Thus, adoption of internaly-oriented initiatives, directed at employees improving service quality and bringing the brand to life, is advocated. Internal branding is a multi-disciplinary practice and a key factor in business and brand success because it is the bridge between business strategy and implementation. A substantial component of this bridge is the employee. It is necessary to understand what is important to employees, i.e., the drivers of employee's engagement. It is also necessary to understand the methodologies for developing and sustaining internal branding initiatives.This creates an alignment between what employees believe the organization should be providing, and what is actually perceived as being provided.

For employees to emotionally feel connected to the company's ethics and values, it is of utmost significance that they connect with and relate to the experiences they go through at the workplace. Positive employee experiences and reinforcements determine the success ofemployee retention strategies and growth of the company's business. The company has to fulfil the commitments made at the time of the candidate's recruitment. This is important due to the personality-job-fit, so that individual ambitions and organisational goals are aligned, for employees to perform to the best of their capabilities. A sense of pride thus blooms with being connected with the company. Thus emerges the concept of Employer Branding and Internal Branding. Organizations around the globe are facing similar business challenges; the difficulty of attracting talent and retaining quality employees, a lack of employee loyalty, increased overseas competition, enhanced generational change and a shortage of skilled labor. So it makes sense that the next big thing that organisations should be focusing on is how to be

better at attracting the right people, making sure to retain them and then better developing those people to deliver on the business objectives and goal.

Branding

From the marketing perspective, branding involves the creation of psychological structures that help the target audience to organise their knowledge with respect to a particular product/organisation. In doing so, the target audience is able to clarify their decision making with respect to that product/organisation andin turn, provides value to an organisation through improved customer buying habits. Branding, however, is not only an opportunity to shape customers' perceptions with respect to the organisation; it is also an opportunity to shape employee perceptions as well. In fact, according to Jacobs, a brand represents the relationship an organisation has with its employees just as much as it represents the relationship that it has with its customers.

Knapps, in her seminal book "The Branding Mindset" (2001), defines a brand as "the internalized sum of all impressions received by consumers resulting in a distinctive position in their mind's eye based on perceived emotional and functional benefits".Davis(2003) understands a brand as "all of the promises and perceptions that an organization wants its customers to feel about its product and service offerings". Kotler (1997) sees it as "a seller's promise to deliver a specific set of features, benefits, and services to the buyers". This is congruent with Blumenthal's approach (2003), which states "brands provide a sense of meaningful identity that is distinct from the particular product or service being offered".

In the context of pure services, it is the actual experience with the brand that dominates customer brand perceptions, of which employees play a major role. Similarly, in relation to the marketing of physical goods, it is the employees who must understand what the brand

means, and how it provides value to consumers, in order for its tangible and intangible components to be developed and delivered accordingly. It is for this primary reason that internal brand management is seen as a significant strategic organizational initiative. Thus the concept of branding when applied in HR and to the employees by treating employees as the internal customers of the organization leads to the creation of a stronger organizational brand. Thereforethe concept of organizational/corporate/employer branding emerges so.

Corporate Branding

A corporate brand has been described as the immediate mental picture that audiences have of an organization (Balmer & Gray, 2003; Harris & De Chernatony, 2001). Corporate identity, as a similar concept, may be used to differentiate a company from its competitors, based on strengths, corporate culture, corporate style, future direction, and CEO reputation (Balmer & Gray, 1997; Board, 2001; Fombrun, 1996).

While corporate identity focuses on the values and behavioral practices that are either determined by the bottom or the top of an organization, the corporate brand consists only of those values and behavioral practices that are relevant to customers (Harris & De Chernatony, 2001; Schultz & Hatch, 1997).Every company, irrespective of its business, marketplace and economic conditions, needs to attract and engage the right people for making the right contributions.. Then, after the new workers walk through the door, the business must earn their loyalty and engagement.

Employer Branding – A New HR Arena

The term'employer brand' was conceptualized by Ambler and Barrow (1996) in their paper, titled "The Employer Brand". An “employer brand” is a collection of ideas and beliefs that

influence the way current and potential employees view an organization and the employment experience that it is offering. It is the image of the organization within as well as in the external marketplace as the“BestPlacetoWork”. Anything an organization does will influence howpeople view its employer brand and the employment experience that it is offering. It helps an organization in identifying itself in the market as an employer of present staff, as a potential employer for new employees, and as having a good relationship with the customers.

The employer branding process makes use of marketing techniques to create powerful positive expectations amongemployees and is portrayed as the cure for key organizational problemssuch as skill shortages, retention difficulties and effective talent management, and hence, should focus on the entire employment experience, organizational personality, and goals and values.From an HR point of view, branding is very important**.**

If the organization has a good brand image in the market, it will help in getting right workforce at right time and at the same time there will be a control over the employee cost.If the organization isclear about its employer brand and is confident that it portrays an accurate impression of the company, then it is likely to hire people who are reliant on its culture and values. If the employer brand delivers on its promise, these staff members will be more willing to stay with an organization. All these factors relate to the strength of the organisation's employer brand and the way that it is perceived internally by current employees and externally by potential future recruits. So employer branding is a marketing tool used in HR to build up the organizational image as the “Best Employer to work with”.Thus itis an emotional relationship between an organisation and its employees.

Branding can be done in two ways:(1) External Branding and **(2) Internal Branding**.

Many factors influence the branding strategy of an organization, like (a) Nature of Business,(b) Nature of market,(c) Target reception, (d) Budget flexibility, (e) Long term mission of the organization,(f) Organizational structure etc.

External branding refers to branding which is done by using external sources and which may (or may not) require some investment in monetary or other forms. The different means of doing external branding are by use of job sites, banners, road shows, corporate social responsibility, public events, newspapers, email, tagline, aligning with celebrity etc.

Internal Branding refers to the process of using the employees of the organization for branding. It includes the various HR processes, policies and strategies of the organization, customer orientation (internal as well as external), marketing and public relation activities.

Internal Branding – A Human Resource Perspective

Internal Branding is the set of strategic processes that align and empower employees to deliver the appropriate customer experience in a consistent fashion. Given that "brand" has moved towards being a customer experience concept, so the ability of employees to deliver that experience has become increasingly salient. Integrated Branding (Parker, 1999), Inclusive/Holistic Branding(Ludlow & Schmidt, 2002) or Internal Branding (Tosty & Stotz, 2001), the concepts may differ by names but the essential idea remains the same. Either of these concepts is concerned with both the employee's need for "living the brand" and the company's image as seen throught the eyes of its associates and its potential hires. Internal Branding is a strategic concept that includes promoting the main corporate brand to the employee base so that they can understand the connection between the brand promise and brand delivery.

Internal brandingcan be defined as the process that enables the employees to know the values of the brand, to develop a positive attitude towards the values and to develop the skills to deliver on the values of the brand. So internal brand building is the process of creating enthusiastic, engaged employees who admire how the organization's values and competencies make a distinctive difference for its customers.

The power of brand is becoming stronger than ever for attracting and retaining talent and internal branding is a product of the 'war for talent'. Aberdeen Group's Benchmark study(2009); Assessments in Talent Management has identified two macro external pressures driving organizations to focus on their employer brand: Increasing competition for top talent in the marketplace(cited by 57% of executives), and Shortage of Key Skills in the markertplace (cited by 38% ofexecutives). It used five key categories: proceses, organization,knowledge management, enablers and performance management to determine if their performance is best in class.

Martin Edwards (2008) studied the roles organisational identification (OID) and personal identity (PI) may play in the future of employer branding. He suggested that OID links the self to the organisation, enabling employee engagement, thus setting the goal for employer branding. Also a positive image and attractive reputation stood as driving factors behind OID, implying that how the employer treated employees was directly linked to the extent to which employees were likely to identify with the company, making them 'walking talking brand agents'. Brammer and Rayton' (2007) focuses on 'the impact of value-based organizational brands on employee perceptions and activities'. The study examines how employees see CSR initiatives and how such perceptions affect employee attitudes and activities in the workplace and help in building company's brand reputation.

Why is Internal Branding Important?

Employees are seen as a crucial element in the brand management, since they represent the brand in the interaction with the customer (Ahmed and Rafiq 2003).Poor staff performance often results in gaps between customer expectations and the brand promise (Parasuraman 1985, 1988). Therefore, employees have to be enabled to deliver the brand image (Keller 2003, Wallace and de Chernatony 2005). They have to know the brand values, need to believe them and act in consistence with these values.

Brand Loyalty:

Competent and dedicated employees are the key factor in getting and retaining customers' loyalty. Turning a brand promise into organizational reality requires coordinated planning and action at all levels.Not only must all messages during the implementation and afterwards be directed at employee touchpoints, but also internal branding is a leadership operation.

Brand values and Person-organization-fit as outcomes of the internal branding process:

Employees have to know the brand values, need to believe them and act in consistence with the values. Increased commitment to delivering the brand promise (Heskett 1987) and a greater likelihood of higher brand performance (Kotter and Heskett, 1992) are seen as positive outcomes of employee's understanding of brand values. The "Person-Organisation Fit (POF)" plays a significant role in closing the gap where employees feel a lack of identification with corporate brand and an unwillingness to support it adequately.POF can be explained as the match between the individual values of employees and those of the actual organization or brand.

Literature Review

The shift away from product branding to corporate branding increased the need for people management issues to be taken into account in the branding process. This led to the concept of 'employer branding,' which replaced that of 'employer of choice' and established people management specialists as a critical part in managing the brand (Bose, 2001; Frook, 2001; Hatfield, 1999; McDonald, 2001; Ruch, 2000; Walsh, 1998; Woods, 2001).

Management literature widely acknowledges that branding -- both corporate and product branding -- may be largely aimed at external audiences, but in fact has important internal implications (Getting it right on the inside: the challenge of internal branding, 2003). Internal branding includes promoting the main corporate brand to the employee base in a fashion that makes them understand the connection between brand promise and brand delivery.In service industries, internal branding has seen a significant rise. Some authors advocate leveraging employees as 'brand ambassadors' (De Chernatony & Segal-Horn, 2001).

A new model, known as living the brand (Ind, 2001; Pringle and Gordon, 2001; Mitchell, 2002) is advertised as strengthening an organization's position in the competitive marketplace while enhancing internal organizational effectiveness.To induce employees to project the brand's identity, organizations engage in employee branding (Edwards, 2005; Harquail, 2005, Miles and Mangold, 2005).The only way to motivate employees to live the brand is to ensure they helped create it; that it is partly theirs (Tosti & Stotz, 2001). Employees must internalize the brand's identity before they can project it to others. (Joseph, 1996; Ind, 2001, 2003; Miles and Mangold, 2004).

Employee branding programs are intended to impress brand attributes onto the work behavior of employees, who are then expected to infuse brand attributes throughout their work (Ind, 2001; Mitchell, 2002; Miles and Mangold, 2004). Branded employees are expected to project the brand's identity through all of their behavior, including their demeanor, appearance, and manner of interacting with customers. Employee branding processes include brand education and brand interface training, formal human resource practices of recruitment, selection, appraisal, and rewards (Edwards, 2005), internal communications, organizational décor and artifacts (Harquail, 2005), and informal socialization processes.

Machtiger (2004) regarded the sole reliance on internal communications as one pitfall in internal branding and suggested a broader integrative framework across marketing, management, and HR disciplines.Internal branding initiatives need supports from communication strategy that take account of both external and internal communication practices (Hallam, 2003). Recent studies (e.g., Hankinson, 2004; Punjaisri & Alan, 2007) have suggested the coordination of the efforts of marketers and HR managers to underpin any internal branding programmes.

Brands come to life through an interplay of the efforts of those managing the brand (typically, a firm) and stakeholders interacting with the brand (customers, shareholders, distribution channels and employees) (Hatch and Shultz, 2009; Kärreman and Rylander, 2009; Holt, 2002). To date the literature has suggested mechanisms that create, perpetuate and shape employer brands from both the firm and employee perspective (e.g., brand meaning, organization identity, employee attraction and internal marketing: Ambler and Barrow, 1996, Knox and Freeman 2006, Backhaus and Tikoo, 2004).

Empirical investigations of the operation of specific mechanisms, such as organisational attractiveness and brand positioning, has followed, typically from the perspective of either the firm or the individual potential/current employee (Lievens and Highhouse, 2003; Berthon, Ewing and Hah 2005; Davies, 2008, Bakhaus, 2004; Ewing et al 2002). When viewed as the constituents of the process associated with how employees interact with the employer brand,the mechanisms encompass brand meaning (Lievens and Highhouse, 2003), brand attraction (Lievens and Highhouse, 2003), employee and organisational fit (Lievens and Highhouse, 2003; Backhaus and Tikoo, 2004), psychological contracts (Backhaus and Tikoo, 2004; Moroko and Uncles, 2008), organisational citizenship behaviour (Backhaus and Tikoo, 2004), and brand loyalty (Ambler and Barrow, 1996).In a survey conducted by Aberdeen Group in 2009, it was found that the firms enjoying Best –in Class performance shared several common characteristics; like 76% of the firms have an employee referral programs, 67% have a process to solicit employee feedback on hiring experience, 65% enable collaboration between HR and communication.

Having identified the role and importance of internal branding, the present study attempts to explore the factors influencing the internal branding process.

Objective of the Study

The broad research objective centres on developing and standardising scales toassess Internal Branding from employee and employer perspective.This study aims at understanding the factors which influence the Internal Branding process, revealing the Employee Perceptions towards the role and the processes that enable them to fulfill the brand promise.

Research Design & Methodology

Research Approach: The research approach adopted is Descriptive and Empirical in nature.

Sample Design: The research was carried out in 4 different organizations across the industry sector, namely IT, Telecom, Banking and Aviation. The companies from IT and Telecom sector were private sector organizations and the companies from Banking and Aviation were public sector organizations. Stratified random sampling was used to select the respondents.The data was collected from a sample of 74 participants from the organizations.

Data Collection: Survey method was used for data collection. Two different sets of specially designed Structured Questionnaires were used to collect data from the employees and the employer(HR representatives).

Data Analysis: The data was analysed to test the reliability of the specially designed questionnaires. Reliability tests such as Cronbach's alpha and Split Half method were used to test the internal consistency of both scales. ANOVA through Friedman's test was carried out to assess the agreement among the raters.

Two different approaches can be used to generate the scale items by researchers: the deductive or the inductive approach (Hinkin 1995). The former approach is based on the development of a classification schema or typology prior to datacollection by a thorough review of the literature. This helps in the development of a theoretical definition of a construct, on the basis of which the scale items are developed (Schwab 1980; Rossiter2002).Based on information generatedfrom prior studies, a pool of items related to

each construct can readily beformulated.In contrast, an inductive approach involves identifying constructsand possible scale items based on qualitative insights obtained from the respondents (Hinkin 1995). This approach is often used when there is limitedtheory or knowledge in relation to a topic.

The present study has a strong deductive foundation based on the various models of internal branding in the literature. Also, feedback was taken from the industry persons in the various areas of internal branding.Two different scales were generated; one for the employees and one for the representatives of the employer (Managers from HR, Internal Branding and Communications, Leadership, Marketing, Public Relations etc.).

The scale for the Employees contains 7 dimensions of Internal Branding, namely Organization, Information and Communication, Management, HR Processes, Citizenship, Brand Equity and Engagement. These 7 dimensions were detailed into 24 variables and a 71 items scale wasdeveloped.

The scale for the Employer contains 6 dimensions of Internal Branding. These are Organization, Communication, HR Processes, Organizational Citizenship Behaviour, Brand Citizenship Behaviour and Employer Brand Equity. These dimensions consist of 20 variables and a total of 60 items were generated. Both the scales focus on multivariate relationships between the constructs. Having developed both scales, they were administered to a convenience sample of 74 employees(64) and representatives of employers(10).

Empirical Analysis

Purification and Reliability

The first stage of scale purification involved the entire instrument undergoing the computation of coefficient alpha (Cronbach, 1951) and Split Half Coefficient.This process was applied to both the scales.The second stage consisted of the elimination of items depending on the corrected item to total correlation.

Table1

Reliability analysis of 71-item Internal Branding Scale (IB-Employees)

Cronbach's Alpha	Cronbach's Alpha Based on Standardized Items	N of Items
.982	.982	71

In case of the Employee scale, for 71 items, the alpha value was 0.982. From the results of this first phase of the reliability analysis all items with a corrected item-to-total correlation of less than 0.40 were eliminated, resulting in the removal of three items.This left a total of 68 items that form the final Internal Branding Scale (IB-Employees) for employees.

Table 2

Reliability analysis of purified 68-item Internal Branding Scale (IB-Employees)

Cronbach's Alpha	Cronbach's Alpha Based on Standardized Items	N of Items
.982	.982	68

The alpha value for the final 68-item scale was found to be 0.982 after eliminating the low correlation value items.

Table 3 (a)

Split Half Reliability Test for 71 itemInternal Branding Scale (IB-Employees)

Reliability Statistics

Cronbach's Alpha	Part 1	Value	0.973
		N of Items	36[a]
	Part 2	Value	0.96
		N of Items	35[b]
		Total N of Items	71
		Correlation Between Forms	0.879
Spearman-Brown Coefficient		Equal Length	0.935
		Unequal Length	0.935
		Guttman Split-Half Coefficient	0.927

The second reliability test was carried out through Split Half method (Spearman-Brown Coefficient. The Guttman Split Half Coefficient value was 0.927 in the first stage. Correlation value of 0.879 shows high correlation between both the halves of the scale.

Table 3 (b)

Split Half Reliability Test for 68 item Internal Branding Scale (IB-Employees)

Reliability Statistics

Cronbach's Alpha	Part 1	Value	0.972
		N of Items	34[a]
	Part 2	Value	0.963
		N of Items	34[b]
		Total N of Items	68
		Correlation Between Forms	0.897
Spearman-Brown Coefficient		Equal Length	0.946
		Unequal Length	0.946
		Guttman Split-Half Coefficient	0.943

Guttman Split-Half Coefficient value rose to 0.943 after elimination of items 3 items, which indicates high reliability of the scale. Both halves of the scale contains 34 items each showing alpha value of 0.972 and 0.963. Moreover, there is high correlation between both the halves of the scale(0.897)

Table 4(a)

Reliability analysis of entire 60-item Internal Branding Scale(IB-Employer)

Reliability Statistics

Cronbach's Alpha	Cronbach's Alpha Based on Standardized Items	N of Items
.953	.946	60

For the Employer Scale, value of alpha was calculated to be 0.953 for all 60 items. From the results of this first phase of the reliability test, all items with a negative corrected item-to-total correlation were eliminated, resulting in the removal of eleven items. Thus a total of 11 items were identified and eliminated.

Table 4(b)

Reliability Analysis for purified 49 item Internal Branding Scale (IB Employer)

Reliability Statistics

Cronbach's Alpha	Cronbach's Alpha Based on Standardized Items	N of Items
.977	.977	49

After elimination of 11 items, the value of alpha increased from .953 to 0.977 for the 49 items. This left a total of 49 items that form the final Internal Branding (IB-Employer) scale for employers. Thus the final scale for measurement (IB –Employer) comprises of 49 items.

Table 5 (a)

Split Half Reliability Analysis for 60item Internal Branding Scale (IB-Employer)

Cronbach's Alpha	Part 1	Value	0.927
		N of Items	30[a*]
	Part 2	Value	0.898
		N of Items	30[b*]
		Total N of Items	60
		Correlation Between Forms	0.848
Spearman-Brown Coefficient		Equal Length	0.918
		Unequal Length	0.918
		Guttman Split-HalfCoefficient	0.917

The second reliability test was done through split half method showing a Spearman-Brown coefficient value of 0.917 for all the 60 items. The first half of the questionnaire consists of 30 items which shows an alpha value of 0.927 (high reliability) and the second half consisting of rest 30 items shows an alpha value of 0.898 which again indicates high degree of reliability.

Table 5 (b)

Split Half Reliability Analysis for 49 item Internal Branding Scale (IB-Employer)

Cronbach's Alpha	Part 1	Value	0.965
		N of Items	25[a]
	Part 2	Value	0.947
		N of Items	24[b]
		Total N of Items	49
		Correlation Between Forms	0.908
Spearman-Brown Coefficient		Equal Length	0.952
		Unequal Length	0.952
		Guttman Split-HalfCoefficient	0.951

The split half reliability test for the 49 item scale shows a Spearman-Brown coefficient value of 0.951 which indicates high reliability of the scale for employer. The first half of the scale consisting of 25 items has an alpha value of 0.965 and the second half with 24 items shows an alpha value of 0.947, which indicates that the scale is highly reliable. Also, both the halves of the scale are highly correlated with a correlation value of 0.908.

ANOVA: Chi square tests were carried out on both the purified scales.

Table 6

Chi square test for 68 item scale for Employees

ANOVA with Friedman's Test						
		Sum of Squares	Df	Mean Square	Friedman's Chi-Square	Sig
Between People		1904.453	54	35.268		
Within People	Between Items	269.194[a]	67	4.018	395.112	.000
	Residual	2241.438	3618	.620		
	Total	2510.632	3685	.681		
Total		4415.085	3739	1.181		

Grand Mean = 3.73, Kendall's coefficient of concordance W = .061.

This is done for assessing the agreement among the raters. The value of W ranges from 0(no agreement) to 1(complete agreement). The value of W indicates that there is some degree of unanimity among the responses.

Table 7

Chi Square-test for 49 item scale for employers

ANOVA with Friedman's Test						
		Sum of Squares	Df	Mean Square	Friedman's Chi-Square	Sig
Between People		118.641	6	19.774		
Within People	Between Items	57.948[a]	48	1.207	102.696	.000
	Residual	131.644	288	.457		
	Total	189.592	336	.564		
Total		308.233	342	.901		

Grand Mean = 3.37, Kendall's coefficient of concordance W = .188. This indicates fairdegree of unanimity among the various responses.

Discussion and Conclusion

Generally,scales are regarded as reliable for academic and commercial purposes if the alpha coefficient exceeds 0.7. Also values of split half coefficient of more than 0.9 are highly reliable. So it can be accepted that IB-Employees and IB-Employer, both are reliable scales for the measurement.

Factors influencing Internal Branding

Thus we observe that internal branding has a positive impact on attitudinal and behavioural aspects of employees in their delivery of the brand promise. There are many factors which act

as link between internal branding and employees' brand performance. The present study identified thefactors of internal branding which are likely to contributeto employment experience and employer brand value.These are identified as Organization, Communication, HR and IB processes, Organizational Citizenship Behaviour, Brand Citizenship Behaviour, Brand Equity, Management and Engagement for the purpose of present study. Brand is a representative of its culture, which includes the set of values, vision, andmission. Culture is the main source ofdifferentiation and acts as a link connecting the individual brand identity tocorporate brand.

The effectiveness and overall success of internalbranding programmes is dependent on an in-depthknowledge and understanding of the internal as wellas the external environment of the organization. Communication needs to be transparent and information needs to be made available to everyone in the organisation. The management dimension is concerned with the degree andnature of visible support given by management to the internal branding programme. The various HR processes for recruiting, motivating and retaining the employees through rewards and recognition, compensation and benefits, training, work, quality of work life balance,autonomy, engagement, exit interviews, participation in decision making, growth and developmental opportunities ; all together create an OCTAPACE culture which is the most important factor for the success or failure of internal branding.

The effectiveness of internal communication, the extent to which employees are motivated to perform well, and the quality of the leadership given by management,all play an important role in retaining staff. Organizational culture and climate and internal change processes influence companys' ability to look inwards to engage the 'hearts and minds' of employees through internal branding.

Internal branding helps employees to go beyond the action formally required by their job descriptions and thus create the organizational citizenship behavior.Thebrandcommitmentis the key driver of brandcitizenship behaviour. It isthe extentof psychological attachment ofemployees to the brand, which influencestheir willingness to exert extraeffort towards reaching the brand goals.The brand promise should be delivered by the organization and the value proposition should be clear at all employee touch points.

Employees shouldbe treated in the same manner as how the organisation wishes their customers to be treated. This is because employees are the first customers(internal customers) of any organisation.Satisfied employees make satisfied customers and satisfied employees can, in turn, reinforce employee's sense of satisfaction in their jobs. Organisations need to adopt a systematic process of internal branding approach so that the employees perform in alignment with the brand values.

Summary

The present research study attempted to study the factors influencing internal branding processes in the organization. To that effect, data was collected from a sample size of 74 and subjected to analysis. The questionnaires were standardized using Cronbach's alpha, Split half reliability tests and Friedman's test and were found to be reliable according to the values. The results show that internal branding is a process dependent on organizational factors such as OCTAPACE culture, communication and information, management support, leadership, teamwork, HR processes, engagement, citizenship behavior and employer brand equity.

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